

Nicholas (Nic) Jones

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Washington, D.C.
Top Secret Clearance

SUMMARY

Hands-on security engineer and published vulnerability researcher with 7+ years across offensive security, AWS and Azure cloud network security, and enterprise security. Currently lead T-Rex's information security program and a network security team for the U.S. Department of Education. AI red-teaming competition winner and repeat SANS NetWars champion.

EXPERIENCE

T-Rex Solutions, LLC (*Bethesda, MD - Remote*) Jun. 2019 – Present

- **Information Security Manager (Jan. 2024 – Present)**
 - Lead T-Rex's information security program, including strategy and security architecture
 - Led successful ISO 27001, NIST SP 800-171, and CMMC audits
 - Rolled out EDR, SIEM, and zero trust architecture across the T-Rex enterprise
 - Overhauled the vulnerability management program and established program metrics
 - Conduct incident response and run tabletop exercises with executives
 - Built TrainRex through T-Rex's AI Hatchery: an AI-powered SCORM builder for company-wide security awareness training
 - Serve as AI Champion for IT & Security, promoting and developing AI use and reporting to the AI Council
- **Lead Information Security Analyst (May 2020 – Jul. 2022)**
 - Conducted periodic penetration tests, managed network infrastructure, and developed incident response exercises
 - Led MITRE ATT&CK adoption and ISO 27001 preparation, and managed the information security intern
- **Cybersecurity Analyst (Aug. 2019 – May 2020)**
 - Reported to the CISO/CIO and led malicious email analysis and vulnerability & patch management
 - Performed cloud security architecture, security awareness training, and network monitoring
- **Cybersecurity Intern (Jun. 2019 – Aug. 2019)**
 - Re-architected the SIEM platform for security event logging and detection
 - Supported Splunk implementation and the development of security procedures, policies, compliance, and training

U.S. Department of Education (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) Sep. 2024 – Present

- **Network Security Manager (Apr. 2025 – Present)**
 - Manage a 5-person network and security team on the Department's PIVOT-H cloud hosting contract
 - Led TIC 3.0 implementation and a full redesign of the AWS and Azure cloud networks
 - Secure traffic with Palo Alto VM-Series firewalls and public endpoints with AWS WAF, CloudFront, and Azure Front Door
- **Cloud Engineer (Sep. 2024 – Apr. 2025)**
 - Hands-on engineer on the team that migrated 20+ systems from a legacy hosting platform to AWS in 3 months

Palantir Technologies (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023

- **Data Engineer (Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023)**
 - Built Palantir Foundry data pipelines for the Department of Energy's National Nuclear Security Administration (NNSA)
 - Developed ETL in Python, PySpark, and TypeScript to ingest, clean, and normalize critical government data

Synack Red Team (*Freelance*) May 2022 – Aug. 2024

- **Security Researcher (May 2022 – Aug. 2024)**
 - Tested web, host, and mobile targets and reported security vulnerabilities for Synack's clients
 - Selected for Synack's vetted researcher program through technical assessments and interviews

Early Career

Applications Tester & Developer – Mobius Intelligent Systems (<i>Laurel, MD - Remote</i>)	May 2019 – Sep. 2019
SOC Analyst/Engineer – Capitol Technology University Cyber Lab (<i>Laurel, MD</i>)	Mar. 2019 – Sep. 2019
Data Technician – ADNET Systems, Inc. (<i>NASA GSFC, Greenbelt, MD</i>)	Dec. 2018 – May 2019
IT Intern – CSRA, Inc. (<i>Falls Church, VA</i>)	Dec. 2017 – Jan. 2018

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Security Engineering – SANS Technology Institute Oct. 2024 – May 2027 (Expected)
• 4.0 GPA, National Cyber League (NCL) Scholarship Winner (Fall 2024 & Spring 2025)

Master of Science in Cybersecurity – Wilmington University Aug. 2021 – Aug. 2023
• Graduated, 4.0 GPA, Epsilon Pi Tau Honor Society

Bachelor of Science in Cyber & Information Security – Capitol Technology University Aug. 2016 – May 2020
• Graduated, 3.8 GPA, Dean's List (x4), Magna Cum Laude, Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society

CERTIFICATIONS

Information Security & Technology Certifications

GIAC Penetration Tester (GPEN)	2026 – 2030
GIAC Certified Intrusion Analyst (GCIA)	2026 – 2030
SANS Security Awareness Professional (SSAP)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Defensible Security Architecture (GDSA)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Strategic Planning & Leadership (GSTRT)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)	2024 – 2028
ISC2 CISSP	2024 – 2027
OSCP	2021 – ∞
CEH	2020 – 2026
ITIL v4 Foundation	2019 – ∞
CompTIA CySA+, Security+, Network+, A+, ITF+	2017 – 2028

Cloud & Development Certifications

GitHub Actions	2024 – 2027
GitHub Foundations	2024 – 2027
ISACA CMMI Associate	2024 – 2027
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional	2023 – 2029
AWS Certified Security Specialty	2022 – 2025
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate	2020 – 2029
Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)	2020 – 2027
AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner	2019 – 2029

VULNERABILITY RESEARCH & PROJECTS

PUBLISHED CVES

CVE-2026-62183 – Apache Syncope: User self-service privilege escalation	Jul. 2026
CVE-2024-43404 – Remote Code Execution Vulnerability in MEGABOT	Aug. 2024

PROJECTS

UNICORD – Security research organization developing proof-of-concept exploits for known CVEs	May 2022 – Present
• CVE-2025-29927: Next.js Middleware Authorization Bypass · CVE-2022-25765: pdfkit Command Injection · CVE-2021-22204: ExifTool Arbitrary Code Execution · CVE-2020-5844: Pandora FMS Remote Code Execution · CVE-2021-3560: Polkit Local Privilege Escalation	
HAMRadioWallet.com – App that adds FCC amateur radio licenses to Apple Wallet and Google Wallet	Jul. 2024 – Sep. 2024
• Built with Next.js and TypeScript · Integrated with Apple Wallet and Google Wallet APIs · Deployed with SST	
GitHub Discord Bot – Serverless bot that subscribes Discord channels to GitHub repository events	Jan. 2024 – Jun. 2024
• Built with AWS Lambda and AWS SQS · Integrated GitHub Webhooks and Discord APIs · Serverless architecture for scalability	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Information Security Engineering:** Cloud-native technologies, SIEMs, Splunk, Sentinel, Penetration Testing, Incident Response, Vulnerability Research, EDR, Zero Trust, Vulnerability Management
- **Governance & Compliance:** ISO 27001, NIST SP 800-171, CMMC, TIC 3.0, Incident Response Tabletop Exercises
- **AI Security & Engineering:** AI Red Teaming, Prompt Injection, AI Agent Security, Internal AI Product Development
- **Cloud Network Security:** AWS VPC, Transit Gateway, Azure VNet, Azure Firewall, NSGs, Palo Alto VM-Series, Hub-and-Spoke Architecture, AWS WAF, CloudFront, Route 53, Azure Front Door
- **Cloud Architecture & Engineering:** AWS, Azure, Serverless Technologies, AWS CDK, Multi-account Architectures
- **Software Development:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, PySpark, PHP, MySQL
- **DevSecOps:** CI/CD, GitHub Workflows, Infrastructure as Code

AWARDS & WINS

huntr "Inside Job" AI Red Teaming Challenge – 1st Place - Overall	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Solo	2025 & 2026
SANS Defense NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS DFIR NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Team Game – 1st Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2026
SANS NetWars Tournament of Champions @ Cyber Defense Initiative – 5th Place - Solo	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Team Game – 3rd Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2025 Team Game – 4th Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
Parsons Cyber CTF – 1st Place (2019), 2nd Place (2024), 3rd Place (2019)	2019 & 2024
CT Cubed CTF @ DEFCON – 1st Place	2023
BSides Charm Exabeam CTF – 1st Place	2023
Maryland Cyber Challenge – 3rd Place	2019
Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout Award – 3 additional palms	2014